HoodBoy Entertainment — DistroKid Catalogue Transfer Guide

Complete Step-by-Step & Click-by-Click Walkthrough (Single, EP, Album & Bulk CSV Transfer)

PRESERVES STREAMS & PLAYLISTS

Portal: https://hbe.lol/distribution | Provider: DistriBeats

Golden Rule of Catalogue Transfers (How Streams & Playlists Are Preserved 100%)

Spotify, Apple Music, and other DSPs match recordings by their exact 12-character ISRC, 12-to-14 digit UPC, track title, and artist name. You MUST submit the transfer in HoodBoy Entertainment FIRST while the old release is still live on DistroKid. Once the transferred release turns "Live" in stores (creating a brief overlap where both versions are merged on Spotify), you can safely remove the release from DistroKid with zero loss of streams, saves, or playlists.

SECTION 1: EXTRACT YOUR METADATA & MASTER FILES FROM DISTROKID

Before opening the transfer form on hbe.lol, log in to DistroKid and gather these exact items for each release:

Step	Where to Click in DistroKid	Exact Data / File to Copy or Download
Step 1.1	**https://distrokid.com/mymusic**	Sign in to DistroKid. Under "My Music", click on the Single, EP, or Album you want to transfer.
Step 1.2	**DistroKid Release Page -> Top Metadata**	Copy the exact Release Title, Artist Name, and Original Release Date (e.g., 2024-03-15).
Step 1.3	**DistroKid Release Page -> Bottom Right ("DistroKid UPC")**	Copy the 12-to-14 digit DistroKid UPC code (e.g., 198588123456). Our system automatically strips any spaces or hyphens.
Step 1.4	**DistroKid Release Page -> Track List ("ISRC")**	Next to every track, copy the 12-character DistroKid ISRC code (e.g., QZK6L2400001). Copy the exact Track Title and Version (if any) for each track.
Step 1.5	**DistroKid Release Page -> Credits / Songwriters**	Click "Credits" or "Plain English" songwriters on DistroKid and note the full legal names of Writers, Composers, Producers, Mixing & Mastering Engineers.
Step 1.6	**https://distrokid.com/vault (DistroKid Vault)**	Open "Goodies" -> "Protect" -> "DistroKid Vault". Click your release to download the original Cover Artwork (.jpg/.png) and Master Audio (.wav/.flac) files.
Step 1.7	**Spotify App / Web -> Your Release Page**	Copy your existing Spotify Album URL (https://open.spotify.com/album/...) and your Spotify Artist URL (https://open.spotify.com/artist/...).

SECTION 2: PRE-FLIGHT CHECK IN HOODBOY ENTERTAINMENT (https://hbe.lol)

Verify your artist profile and live DistriBeats connection before creating transfer drafts:

Step	Where to Click on hbe.lol	Exact Action & Expected Result
Step 2.1	**Left Sidebar -> Artists**	Ensure the Artist exists in your workspace with the exact same Stage Name / Artist Name as on DistroKid and Spotify. If not, click "+ Add Artist" and save.
Step 2.2	**Left Sidebar -> Distribution**	Verify the top-right badge shows "DistriBeats connected (LIVE)" (or TEST if practicing in sandbox).
Step 2.3	**Choose Your Transfer Mode**	For 1 release at a time, click the "Catalogue Transfer" tab (Section 3 below). For 2 to 100 releases at once, click the "Bulk Import" tab (Section 6 on Page 4).

SECTION 3: METHOD A — TRANSFER A RELEASE VIA THE "CATALOGUE TRANSFER" TAB

Click "Distribution" -> "Catalogue Transfer" tab (or click the "Transfer Catalogue" button). Fill in the Blue Transfer Box & Section 1:

Form Field Label	What to Enter / Select	DistroKid Source & System Validation Rule
Current distributor *	Select "DistroKid" (selected by default)	Identifies DistroKid as the source distributor for transfer tracking.
Existing release URL *	https://open.spotify.com/album/...	Paste the live Spotify Album link (or Apple Music / DistroKid link). Must start with https://.
Keep-Live Confirmation Checkbox *	CHECK THIS BOX	Confirms you will keep the DistroKid release live until the transferred release is live in all selected stores.
Release title *	Exact title from DistroKid	Must match your DistroKid release title character-for-character (for Singles, Track 1 title auto-syncs).
Primary artist *	Select the matching Artist	Links the release to your workspace artist profile.
Release type *	Single, EP, or Album	Select Single (1 track), EP (multiple tracks), or Album to match the original release.
Genre & Sub-genre *	Select closest matching Genre & Sub-genre	Loaded from the live DistriBeats catalogue (122 genres).
Language *	Select release language (e.g., English)	Loaded from the live DistriBeats catalogue (54 languages).
Release date * (Delivery Date)	Pick a date at least 9 days in the future	This is the DistriBeats processing/delivery date. Stores will still display your Original Release Date below!
Original release date *	Enter the original DistroKid release date (e.g. 2024-03-15)	MANDATORY for Catalogue Transfers. Must be in the past/today. Preserves chronological album order on Spotify.
UPC / EAN * (existing DistroKid code)	Enter the 12–14 digit DistroKid UPC	MANDATORY for Catalogue Transfers. Ensures stores merge the album container with your existing release.
Copyright owner (cLine) *	e.g., 2024 HoodBoy Entertainment	Preserves your original 4-digit copyright year (e.g. 2024) in the mapped cLine.
Publishing / Master owner (pLine)	e.g., 2024 HoodBoy Entertainment	Preserves your original 4-digit master year in the mapped pLine.
Spotify artist URL	https://open.spotify.com/artist/...	Strongly recommended for transfers so the release maps directly to your existing Spotify artist profile.
Cover artwork *	Upload the cover art from DistroKid Vault	Auto-Adjust Built-In: Even if your DistroKid Vault image is 1400x1400 or 2000x2000 px, the system automatically converts it to 3000x3000 px RGB!
Age & Rights Checkboxes *	CHECK BOTH BOXES	Required DistriBeats age and master/publishing rights attestations.

SECTION 4: SELECT STORES, TERRITORIES & FILL TRACK DETAILS (WITH ORIGINAL ISRC)

Continue scrolling down the Catalogue Transfer form to complete Sections 2, 3, and 4:

Section / Field Label	What to Enter / Select	DistroKid Source & System Validation Rule
2. Stores *	Click "All General" or select Spotify, Apple Music, etc.	Select every store where your DistroKid release is currently live so all DSPs receive the transfer.
3. Territories (ISO 3166-1)	Keep "Worldwide" active	Delivers worldwide (or select specific ISO territories if your release is region-restricted).
4. Tracks -> "+ Add Track"	Click "+ Add Track" for EPs / Albums	Add one track card for each track on your DistroKid release in the exact same track order (Track 1, Track 2, etc.).
Track title * & Version	Exact Track Title & Version from DistroKid	Must match the existing track title on Spotify/DistroKid so stream counts merge cleanly.
ISRC * (use original)	Paste the 12-character DistroKid ISRC (e.g. QZK6L2400001)	MANDATORY for Catalogue Transfers! This is the most critical identifier that preserves your Spotify streams and playlist placements.
Language, Composition & Recording Rights *	Language: English | Composition: Original | Rights: Original	If transferring a cover song or licensed beat requiring proof, select "Cover" or "Licensed" and enter the HTTPS Rights-Proof URL.
Composers, Writers, Producers, Mixing & Mastering Engineers *	Enter full legal names (First Last), comma-separated	DistriBeats requires full legal names for all five credit roles on every track (Writers are optional only if "Instrumental" is checked).
Performers & Roles *	Enter Performer Name + select Role (e.g. "Lead Vocals")	At least 1 performer with an official DistriBeats role is required per track.
Master audio file (WAV or FLAC) *	Select the original .wav or .flac file from DistroKid Vault	Upload the exact master audio file (up to 300 MB). MP3/M4A files are rejected; if DistroKid Vault gives an MP3, convert the master to 16-bit/24-bit WAV first.
Explicit lyrics / Instrumental	Match your original DistroKid explicit/instrumental flags	Check "Explicit lyrics" if the track was marked explicit on DistroKid.

SECTION 5: SAVE TRANSFER DRAFT, APPROVE QC & SUBMIT TO DISTRIBEATS

Complete the submission workflow from draft creation to live delivery:

Step	Where to Click	Exact Action & Expected Result
Step 5.1	**Bottom-Right -> "Save Transfer Draft"**	Click the purple "Save Transfer Draft" button. Your release appears in the "Catalog" tab with a blue "TRANSFER" badge.
Step 5.2	**Top Tab Bar -> "Admin QC"**	Click the "Admin QC" tab, review the transfer metadata, and click the green "Approve" button to mark it "ready for distribution".
Step 5.3	**Catalog Tab -> "Submit" Button**	Return to the "Catalog" tab and click "Submit" (or check multiple ready rows and click "Submit Ready"). The system uploads the release, cover art, and WAV masters to DistriBeats.

SECTION 6: METHOD B — BULK DISTROKID TRANSFER (UP TO 100 RELEASES VIA CSV)

Have many DistroKid releases to transfer? Use the Bulk Import tool to create up to 100 transfer drafts (500 tracks) from one spreadsheet:

Step	Where to Click in Bulk Import	Exact Action & Expected Result
Step 6.1	**Distribution -> "Bulk Import" Tab**	Click the "Bulk Import" tab (or the green "Bulk Import" button on the Catalog bar).
Step 6.2	**Top-Right -> "DistroKid Transfer CSV Template"**	Click the blue "DistroKid Transfer CSV Template" button. This downloads "hbe-distrokid-transfer-template.csv" pre-configured with a Single transfer example ("dk-single-001") and a 2-track EP transfer example ("dk-ep-002").
Step 6.3	**Fill Out the CSV in Excel / Google Sheets**	Use one row per track. Set mode = "catalog_transfer" and source_distributor = "DistroKid". For multi-track EPs/Albums, repeat the same release_key on each track row and set track_number = 1, 2, 3... Separate multiple stores or names with "|" (e.g. "Spotify|Apple Music") and format performers as "Legal Name::Lead Vocals".
Step 6.4	**Upload "CSV manifest *" & "Artwork and master files *"**	Select your saved .csv file on the left, and select ALL cover images (.jpg/.png) and audio files (.wav/.flac) at once on the right. Every cover image is automatically converted to 3000x3000 px RGB during upload!
Step 6.5	**Check Preflight Table & 3 Batch Confirmations**	Verify the summary shows "0 preflight issues" and green "Ready" status on every row. Check all 3 confirmation boxes (Age, Rights, and Keep Source Release Live).
Step 6.6	**Click "Create X Drafts" -> Approve QC -> Bulk Submit**	Click "Create Drafts". Approve the drafts in "Admin QC", then on the "Catalog" tab check the top-left "Select all ready drafts" box and click the green "Submit Ready" button!

SECTION 7: FINAL STEP — WHEN & HOW TO REMOVE THE OLD RELEASE FROM DISTROKID

Follow this exact sequence after submitting your transfer so you never lose a single stream or playlist placement:

Step	Where to Check / Click	Exact Verification & Action
Step 7.1	**Wait for Status = "Live" on hbe.lol**	Monitor your release in "Distribution -> Catalog". Wait until the status changes from "Submitted / Delivered" to "Live" (typically 2 to 5 business days after store delivery).
Step 7.2	**Verify Track Linking on Spotify Desktop App**	Open your album on the Spotify Desktop App. Verify that your tracks show their original play counts (and if Spotify shows a "1 more release" dropdown in the bottom-right corner, both versions are linked!).
Step 7.3	**Remove the Old Release Inside DistroKid**	Now open https://distrokid.com/mymusic -> click the release -> click "Edit Release" -> scroll to the very bottom and click "Remove this release from all stores". Spotify & Apple Music will seamlessly keep the new DistriBeats version live with 100% of your streams and playlists intact.

Troubleshooting Quick Tips for DistroKid Transfers

1. "ISRC format is invalid": Make sure your ISRC has 12 alphanumeric characters (e.g. QZK6L2400001). Hyphens and spaces are stripped automatically.
2. "Cover artwork must be 3000x3000": Both the Single/Album form and Bulk Import automatically resize any JPG/PNG from DistroKid Vault to 3000x3000 px RGB.
3. "Master audio must be WAV or FLAC": DistriBeats requires uncompressed/lossless masters. Do not upload MP3 files.